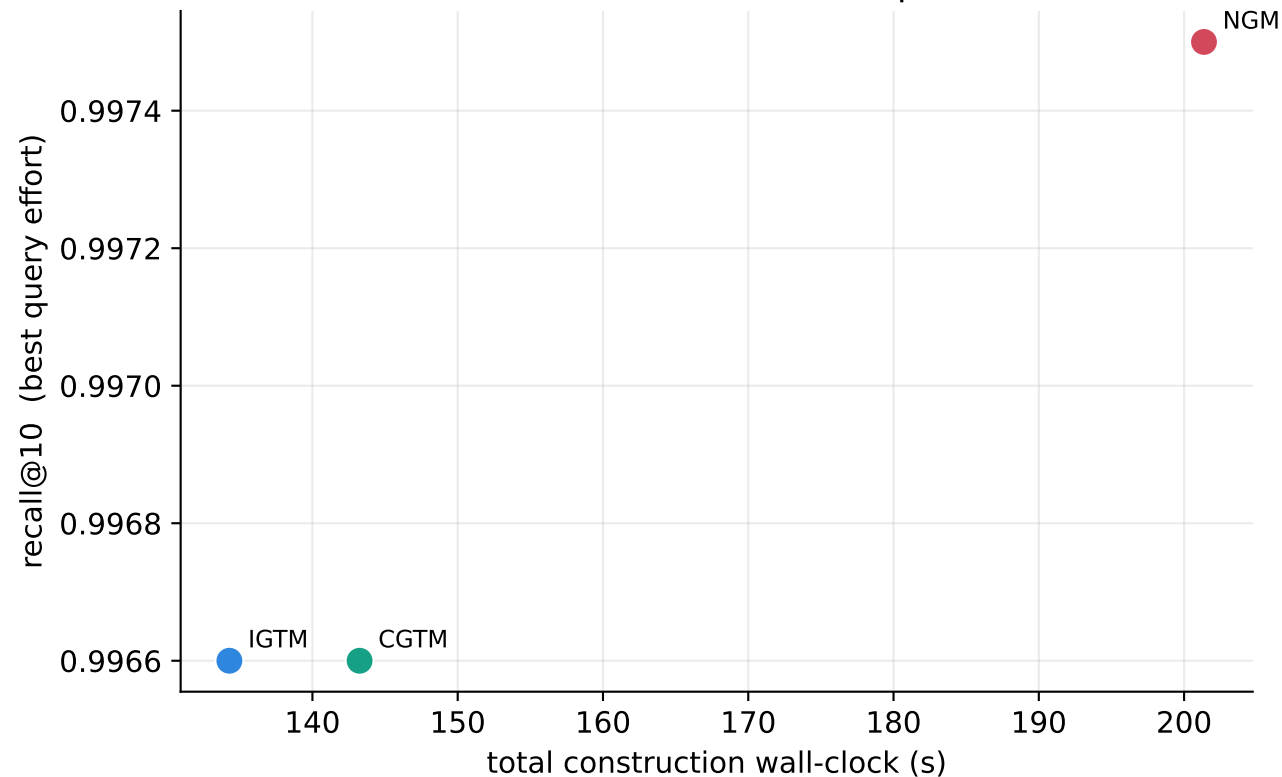


Construction cost vs achieved recall, 2 partitions (SIFT1M)



Caveat: merge recall is best-ef on a navigable HNSW; NN-Descent recall is best-epsilon on a flat k-NN graph ($\neq$ controlled).
NN-Descent is Numba-Python vs C++ merge — time is a ballpark.